
Detailed unit content

Section 1.1 Believing in God

This section is based on a study of one religion only.

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — agnosticism, atheism, conversion, free will, miracle, moral evil, natural evil, numinous, omni-benevolent, omnipotent, omniscient, prayer

- The main features of a religious upbringing in one religion and how it may lead to belief in God.
- How religious experiences, as seen in the numinous, conversion, miracles and prayer, may lead to belief in God.
- The argument from design and how it may, or may not, lead to belief in God.
- The argument from causation and how it may, or may not, lead to belief in God.
- Why scientific explanations of the origins of the world may lead some people not to believe in God.
- How one religion responds to scientific explanations of the origins of the world.
- Why unanswered prayers may lead some people not to believe in God.
- How one religion responds to the problem of unanswered prayers.
- Why evil and suffering may lead some people not to believe in God.
- How one religion responds to the problem of evil and suffering.
- How two television and/or radio programmes and/or films about religion may affect a person's attitude to belief in God.